

DOES THIS SECTION
EVEN NEED AN
INTRODUCTION?
FROM COMPUTERS
TO MOBILES, AND
HEADPHONES TO
GPUS, IT'S ALL
HERE...

IDENTIFY YOURSELF

THIS MONTH IN TECH:

One look at this month's tech section and you might suppose that we had an identity crisis, with Origins of biometrics and State of Face Detection. Also, build Alexa skills, check out India's Agritech startups and more.



Firefox back to Google

Firefox's latest browser, Quantum is arguably the best browser out there right now. Yahoo has been the default search engine for Firefox since 2014 but if you've made the switch, you will notice that the default is now back to Google.

<http://dgit.in/googonfox>

WHAT'S NEW

FCC vs Net neutrality

In what's been going on for months now, this thanksgiving, the FCC went ahead and released their new net neutrality policies which they plan to put into effect this December 15. Many are pointing out that they specifically chose the holiday season to roll out the policy so that the masses would be too distracted to take notice. They released a fact sheet as well which explains what exactly Ajit Pai, Chairman of the FCC, has planned for the industry.

The new rules roll back the Title II classification of ISPs as common carriers. What this means is that ISPs will now be able to govern and decide on schemes/plans/prices of their services on their own. The FCC is giving up on its ability to enforce net neutrality.

While all major players in the broadband industry are going out of their way trying to explain to consumers that the new policies will not kill net neutrality protections, several publications and articles have explained at length about how that's BS.

In the US there's already the problem of giant broadband providers dominating the markets and abusing the lack of competition. This

lack of competition is something FCC chairman Ajit Pai seems to believe does not exist. But either way, going forward with the FCC's new policy means that such providers only become more powerful and are free to abuse their consumers in whatever way they see fit.

It wouldn't be too different from the somewhat recent Free Basics vs Net neutrality issue

we had over here. Rather than being an open entity, the internet would end up breaking up into packets, where the user would have to pay to make use of otherwise free features. Net neutrality is important. The Internet as we know it right now is open to all, we're free to access whatever sites we please and use whatever Internet based services we want. Killing net neutrality means that providers will be able to

censor and block content from their users and only give them access to the content they want them to see. This also allows them to abuse their consumers by putting content behind paywalls, forcing them to pay to unlock the same. The result here has far reaching consequences, especially in developing countries that look to the United States for direction.

<http://dgit.in/fccNN>



Linux dominates supercomputers

Today, all 500 of the supercomputers on the TOP500 Supercomputer list are running on Linux. Linux first appeared in the TOP500 list almost 30 years ago in 1998, and it has evidently progressed by leaps and bounds ever since. Are you on Linux?

<http://dgit.in/lintop500>



Germany's windy weekend

A stormy weekend in Germany led to a record in wind generated electricity with a whopping 39,409 megawatts being generated on Saturday. If you need a scale to comprehend that, that's the equivalent to the energy output of about 40 full-fledged nuclear reactors.

<http://dgit.in/gerwind>



Cryptocurrencies to be illegal in Vietnam

Starting 2018, the State bank of Vietnam has announced that it will be illegal to issue, supply and otherwise use Bitcoin or any other form of cryptocurrency. Doing so can subject you to a \$9000 fine. Which, right now you can pay with one Bitcoin.

<http://dgit.in/vietbit>